6.22 Ascites and Paracentesis

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I cannot breathe well with this big belly." **Objective** • Ascites tense • RR 26/min • Using accessory muscles	**ACTUAL** **Ineffective breathing pattern** related to pressure of ascites on the diaphragm as evidenced by dyspnea and tachypnea.	After paracentesis, says breathing is easier.	• Sit him semi-Fowler. • Ask him to empty his bladder before the procedure. • Take baseline vital signs and weight. • Record how much fluid comes off and what it looks like. • After large-volume drainage, give albumin as ordered.	Breathing easier: **goal met**.
Subjective • "My abdomen feels heavy and tight." **Objective** • Abdomen distended • Keeps changing position	**ACTUAL** **Impaired comfort** related to abdominal distension as evidenced by reported discomfort.	Says he is more comfortable.	• Support him with pillows. • Give him loose clothes. • Give analgesia if prescribed.	Comfortable: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Had large-volume paracentesis	**RISK** **Risk for deficient fluid volume** as evidenced by risk factors: rapid fluid shift after drainage.	BP stays stable after the procedure.	• Check BP and HR during the procedure and afterwards. • Check the puncture site for leaking. • Weigh him the next day.	Vital signs stable: **goal met**.